

Using Splunk

What is Splunk?

Splunk is a data platform that collects, indexes, and analyzes machine-generated data from IT infrastructure, applications, and cloud services. It provides real-time monitoring and dashboards to troubleshoot issues, detect security threats, and analyze operational data.

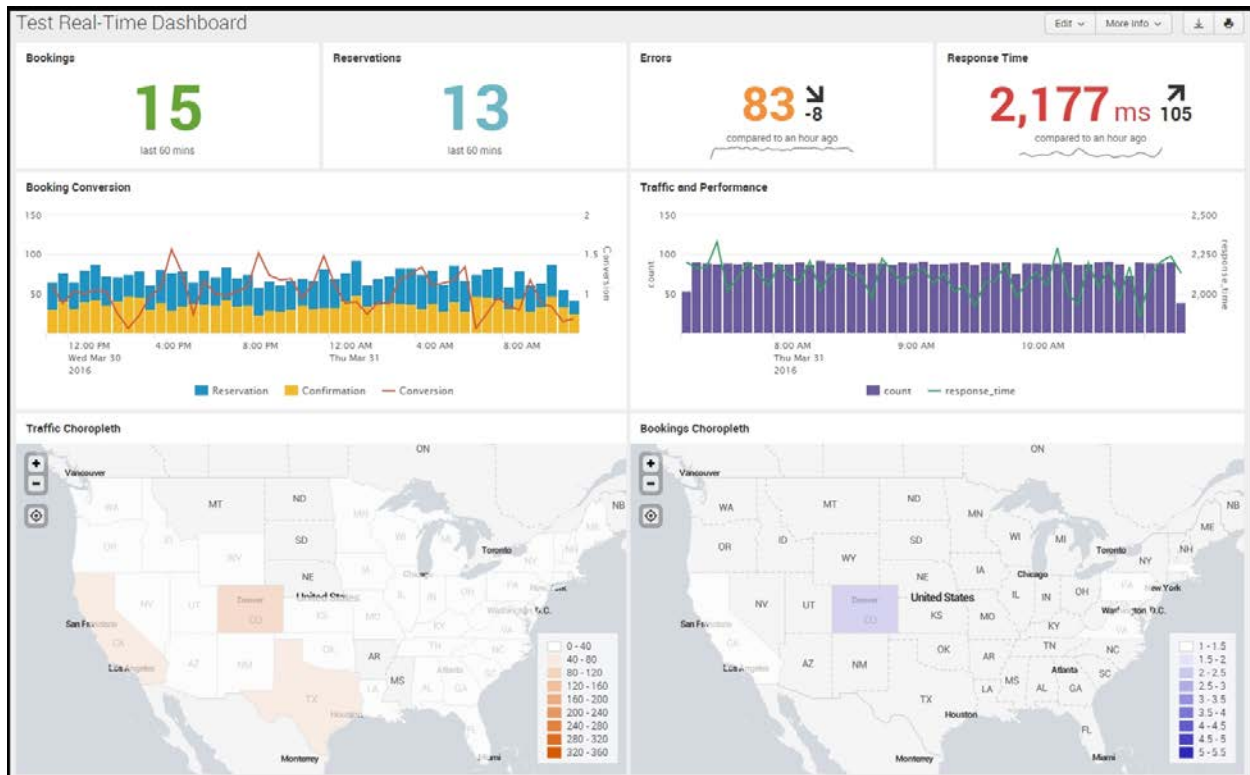


Figure 1 Sample Splunk panels

How do I ...

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Log in to Splunk

Note: Images are sample screens. Some minor variations possibly exist.

1. Open Splunk Enterprise. The log in pop up appears.
2. Enter your Username.
3. Enter your Password.
4. Click Sign in.

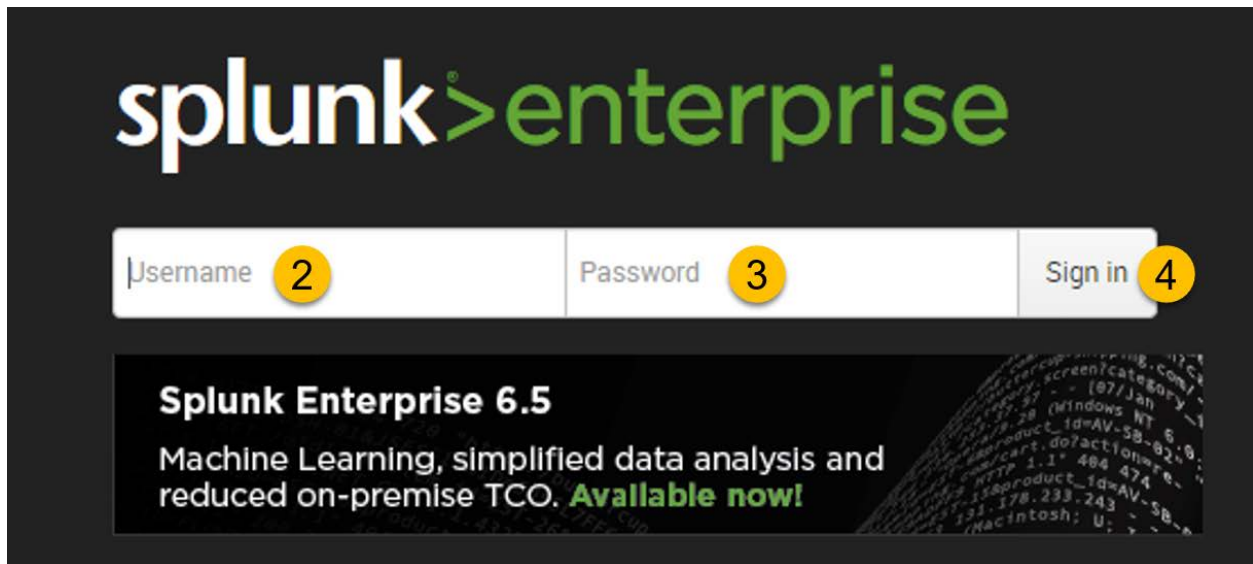


Figure 2 Splunk log in pop up

After you log in, you are redirected to the Splunk App for your account showing the default EC2 Instances dashboard.

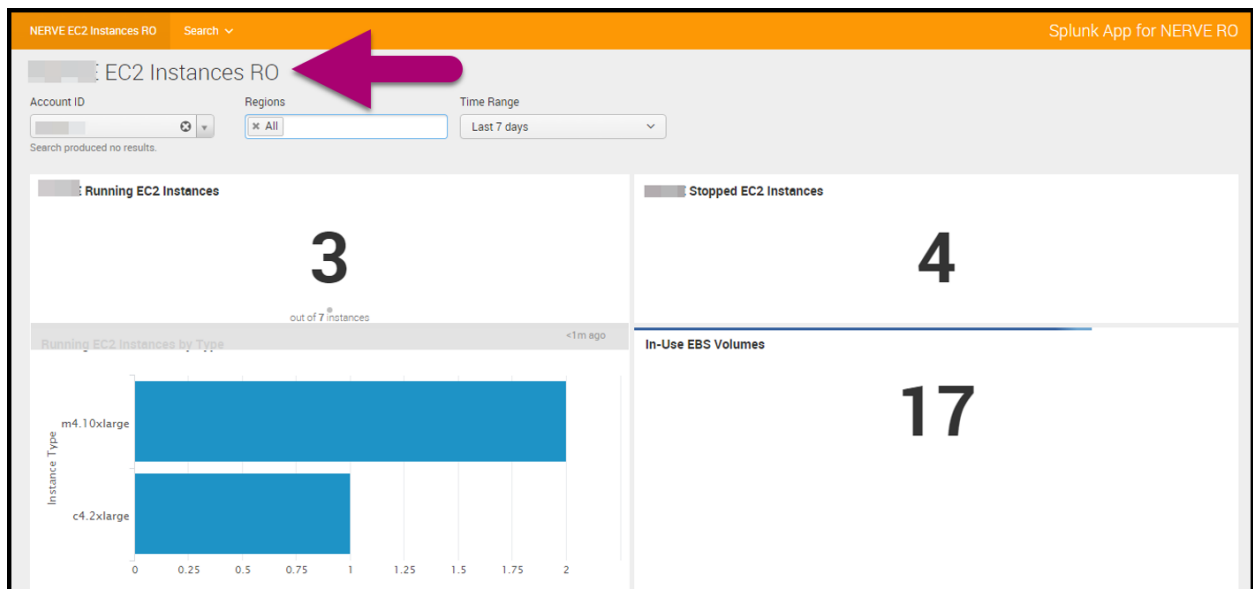


Figure 3 EC2 instances dashboard

Set up Panels

What are Panels?

Splunk panels display visualizations such as charts, tables, maps, or single-value numbers. They connect to data searches to turn raw logs into actionable insights, including inline searches or reports. Panels can be rearranged, edited, and shared to create interactive data displays.

Panel Options

Select settings at the top of the dashboard to view the specified data.

Note: Time is reloaded based on the selected time range.

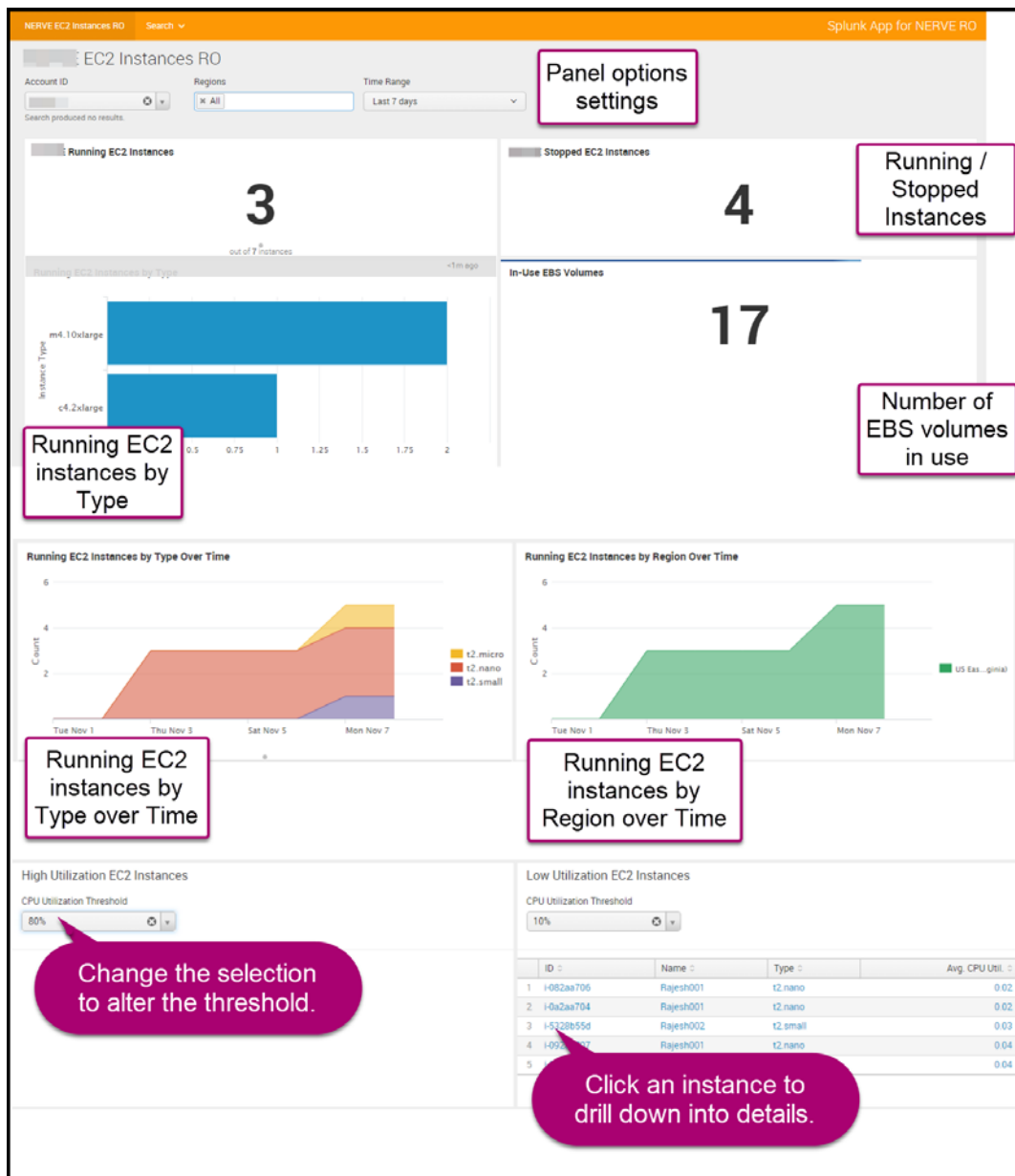


Figure 4 Splunk dashboard details

Terminology

Note: As we add more content, we'll update this section with more terms.

Term	Acronym	Definition
Amazon Web Services	AWS	A secure cloud services platform that offers compute power, database storage, content delivery, and other functionality.
Availability Zones	AZ	One or more discrete data centers with redundant power, networking, and connectivity in an AWS Region.
Database	DB	A digital collection of data and the structure around which the data is organized. The data is typically entered into and accessed via a Database Management System (DBMS).
Elastic Compute Cloud	EC2	Provides scalable computing capacity in AWS cloud. A virtual computer, very similar to a desktop / laptop computer.
Relational Database Service	RDS	SQL database service that provides a wide range of SQL database options to select from.